Check both axes before printing a sewing pattern

A test-square workflow with three digital examples

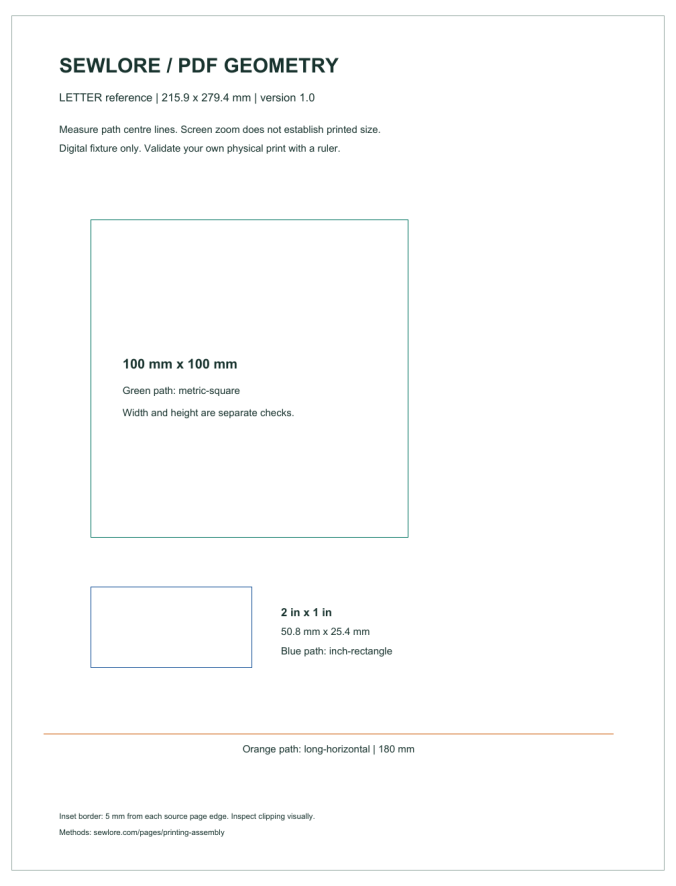
sewlore.com

The pattern's test page

Use the reference shape and dimensions supplied with your actual pattern.

Measure width and height separately.
Use the exact edges or marks specified.
Keep the units the same.

A 100 mm square is this deck's example.
Your pattern may use another reference.



One calculation for each axis

Scale (%) = measured / intended x 100

Error (%) = (measured - intended) / intended x 100

A negative error is shorter. A positive error is longer.

The two axes remain separate, even when their results agree.

Digital reference: 100% on both axes

Axis	Target	Output
Width	100 mm	100 mm
Height	100 mm	100 mm

Width scale 100%
Height scale 100%



Generated PDF geometry; illustration is not a ruler.

Uniform change: 95% on both axes

Axis	Target	Output
Width	100 mm	95 mm
Height	100 mm	95 mm

Width error -5%
Height error -5%

Equal errors indicate a uniform change in this control.

Digital control; original labels are unchanged. Not a ruler.

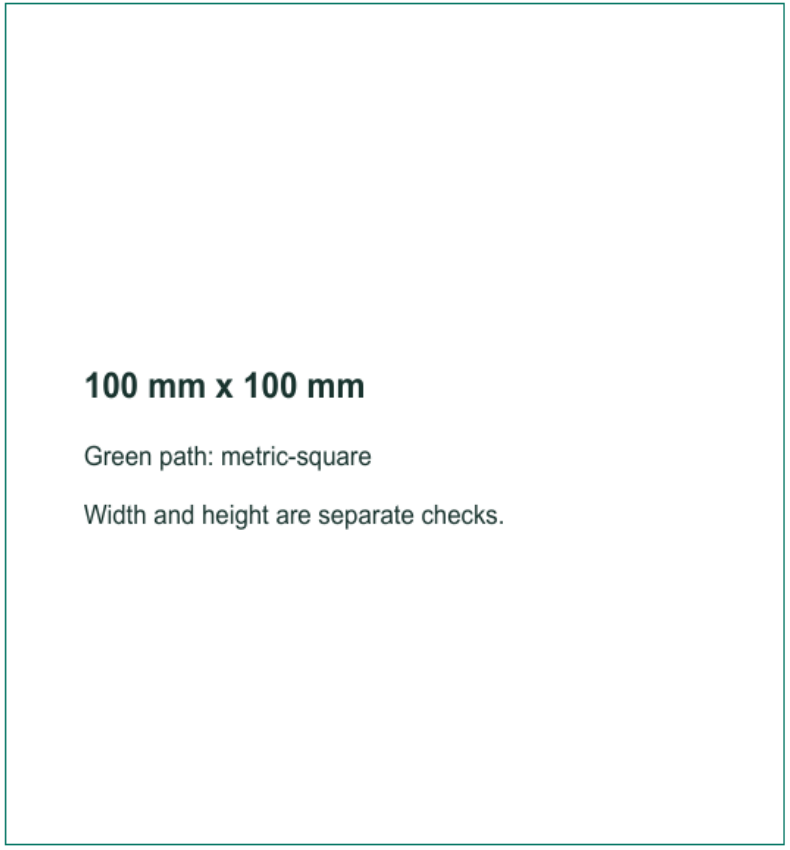


Unequal change: 96% width, 104% height

Axis	Output	Error
Width	96 mm	-4%
Height	104 mm	+4%

One axis is shorter.
The other is longer.

A single uniform setting cannot correct both axes.



Digital control; original labels are unchanged. Not a ruler.

Averaging hides the problem

(96% + 104%) / 2 = 100%

The average looks correct.
The width and height are still wrong.

Even a uniform adjustment that brings 96 mm to 100 mm would bring 104 mm to about 108.33 mm.

A4 and US Letter are different sizes

Paper	Width	Height
A4	210 mm	297 mm
US Letter	215.9 mm	279.4 mm

Choose the pattern file made for your paper format.

A paper mismatch can change scaling or clip content.
There is no universal correction percentage for every printer.

Print settings for the first test page

1 **Follow the pattern's stated printing scale.**

2 For a full-size file, use the reader's Actual size or 100%.

3 Check the selected paper format and printer driver.

4 **Print only the reference page, then measure it.**

Reader labels differ. Adobe defines Fit as scaling to the printable area.
Pattern-specific instructions take priority.

Digital geometry and paper measurements

In this presentation

Known PDF transformations.
Extracted vector path dimensions.
No physical printer tests.

Before using a printed pattern

Measure the actual sheet.
Inspect clipping and registration marks.
Use the publisher's tolerance.

A square alone cannot confirm complete pages, garment fit,
or the accuracy of the entire pattern.

Record, resolve, reprint

Record both dimensions and the current settings.

If either axis is wrong, remeasure the stated reference marks.
Check the source file, paper format, reader and driver.

After changing a setting, print a fresh test page.

Keep the settings that reproduce the required dimensions
before printing the remaining pages.

Guides, calculator and reproducible files

Sewlore printing and assembly guide

PDF pattern print scale checker

Digital PDF geometry kit and source measurements

Adobe Acrobat: page size and print scaling

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Examples describe digital controls, not physical print experiments.